admiration and didn't wear harshness even on his face. But Babur certainly wanted to do worse, but he didn't for some obvious reasons as he sees:[*]

> If I had had that Muhammad Ḥussayn Mīrzā cut in pieces, there was the ground for it that he had had part in base and shameful action, started and spurred on mutiny and treason. Death, he deserved with one after another of varied pain and torture, but because there had come to be various connection between us, his very sons and daughters being by my own mother's sister Khūb Nigār Khānum, I kept this just claim in mind, let him go free, and permitted him to set out towards Khurāsān.

But as Babur has claimed in *Baburnama*, he did not keep the worth of the amnesty given by the former:

> The cowardly ingrate then forgot altogether the good I did him by the gift of his life; he blamed and slandered me to Shaybāni Khān. Little time passed, however, before the Khān gave him his deserts by death.

And he writes the below couplet:

> Leave thou to Fate the man who does thee wrong,
>
> For Fate is an avenging servitor.

Babur sent Aḥmad-i-qāsim Kohbur with a party of braves in the pursuit of Mīrzā Khān. Finally, he was caught in the low hills of Qargha-yīlāq. He tried his best to run away but failed. He was brought in front of Babur, who was seated on the north-east porch, of the old courthouse. Looking at him Babur said, 'Come! let's have a look at one another.'

As per the custom, twice before he could bend the knee and come forward, he fell because of the distress he was in. But he picked himself and came up to Babur. Both looked at each other. Babur placed him by his side. Sherbet was served which he initially denied taking. Upon insistence, he feared that it was poisoned. Babur smiled, took the sherbet and drank it one gulp.

Yet those who had accompanied him (soldiers, peasants, Moghūls and Chaghatāīs) were in suspense. They feared that Mīrzā Khān would be assassinated. But Babur simply ordered Mīrzā Khān to live in his elder sister's house for a few days. His well-wishers, who feared for his life in Kābul, kept insisting on his release. A few days later he was allowed to move to Khurāsān.

Once they were released, Babur went for an excursion to Bārān,[32] Chāsh-tūpa, and the skirt of Gul-i-bahār. Babur claims that the open land of Bārān, the plain of Chāsh-tūpa, and the skirt of Gul-i-bahār were more beautiful in spring than any part of Kābul. Babur saw various kinds of tulips appearing, which he